

From Dev To Architect : 8 Mindset Shifts You Can Start Today

Bassem Ismaiel
Salesforce Lead Architect

Sally ElGhoul
Salesforce Lead Developer & Architect



Learn more about Bassem Ismaiel



Bassem Ismaiel

Lead Salesforce Architect, Electric Mind
Founder, Yalla Salesforce

19+

years in tech

12

years in Salesforce

27

Salesforce certs

50

Superbadges

Architect credentials: Application, System, and B2B Solution Architect

Trailhead: All Star Ranger, Agentblazer Legend

Journey: Egypt, United Kingdom, Canada

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/bassem-ismaiel](https://www.linkedin.com/in/bassem-ismaiel)

YouTube: [youtube.com/@YallaSalesforce](https://www.youtube.com/@YallaSalesforce)

Bassem's Journey

19+ years | 3 countries | 12 years in Salesforce | 27 Salesforce certifications



2007

Starts in Business Intelligence in Egypt

2011

Data Warehouse Architect at CIB

2014

Moves to London and enters the Salesforce ecosystem

2016

Moves to Canada as a Salesforce Data Architect

2018

First Salesforce certification:
Platform Administrator
2x Certified

2020

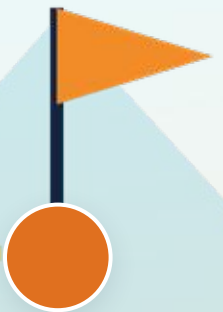
Data Architect Certified
3x Certified
Ranger

2022

Joined Salesforce
as Technical Architect;
Certified Application Architect
12x Certified

2026

Lead Architect at Electric Mind
System Architect, Agentblazer
Legend
27x Certified



Learn more about Yalla Salesforce



Zero to Hero

Founded by Bassem Ismaiel | June 2024 | Arabic and English

Bassem dropped all his ranks and restarted Trailhead from zero, with one account in English and one in Arabic, to show anyone the path to a Salesforce career.



The idea

- Salesforce can be for everyone
- Help non-technology people start a new career
- Show the path from the very beginning
- Prove Ranger is achievable in small steps

The learning path

- Step 1** Trailhead from zero to Ranger, in small increments
- Step 2** First 3 certifications: Admin, App Builder, Platform Foundations

86

Trailhead badges

63,775

Trailhead points

1,300+

YouTube subscribers

160+

videos, Arabic and English

8,000+

YouTube watch hours

1,380+

LinkedIn followers

Follow Yalla Salesforce



YouTube

1,300+ subscribers | 160+ videos



Scan to follow

youtube.com/@YallaSalesforce

LinkedIn

1,380+ followers



Scan to follow

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Agenda

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02 8 shifts, already in reach

03 You already think like an architect

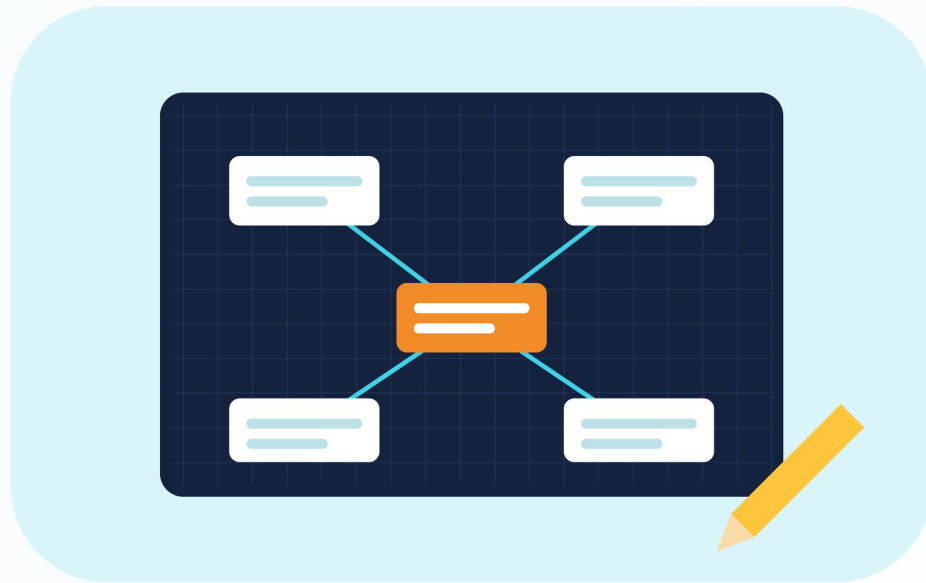
04 What to learn next

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06 Resources



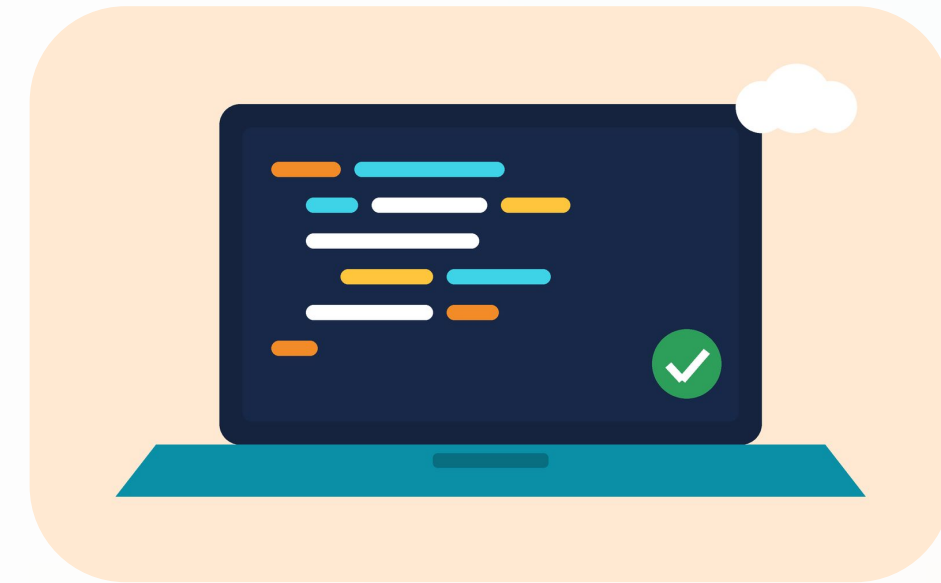
One goal. You're closer than you think.



Architect : It's the right thing

The bridge between business and technology.

Decides what to build, how it fits the whole system, and why it holds at scale.



Developer : Builds it right

Turns a clear spec into working, tested, maintainable software.

You don't flip a switch from developer to architect.
You practice it while you're still writing code.

8 shifts, already in reach



1

When you join

Architects shape the spec.
Developers build from it.

2

How you handle the ask

Architects question the ask.
Developers clarify the ticket.

3

How you communicate

Architects talk business and tech, by audience.
Developers talk tech, with the team.

4

What you diagram

Architects map the system.
Developers draw the feature.



8 shifts, already in reach



5

How you choose tools

Architects pick across the platform and beyond.
Developers pick within the task.

6

How far you think ahead

Architects think in years
Developers think in sprints.

7

What you deliver

Architects own the decision and write it down.
Developers build the solution and ship the code.

8

Your day-to-day

Architects decide and Communicate all day.
Developers build all day.



You already think like an architect



WHY

The business case

The problem worth solving

Devs already ask "why this ticket?".

knowing the outcome the business wants often changes how you build it.



WHAT

Break it down

Slice into user stories per persona and journey

Devs split the ticket into **subtasks** and decide **config vs. code**: solve it with clicks, or build it custom.



HOW

Design it

Options & trade-offs: declarative vs. custom, pick the pattern.

Devs dig into the **implementation**: the actual patterns, the logic, how the pieces fit together.



WHY

The decision

Diagram it & record the rationale

Good devs already **document**.

ERDs, flowcharts, sequence diagrams, code comments.

What to learn next

AI is now a core Architect Skill



How Architects Use AI on Daily Basis?

- Research & learn a new domain fast.
- Summarize docs, threads & requirements.
- Draft diagrams, Architecture Decision Record (ADRs) & first-pass designs.
- Validate & review : poke holes in your own design.
- Generate decks & documents from your findings.

Critical Rule!

AI drafts. You decide.

- 100% human review, always as AI hallucinates.
- The architect owns the decision and the why.



What to learn next

Pick up the architect's drawing tools — start now

Lucidchart

- The official Salesforce shape library lives here.
- what CTAs use on the review board.
- Start with the framework templates.

Mermaid

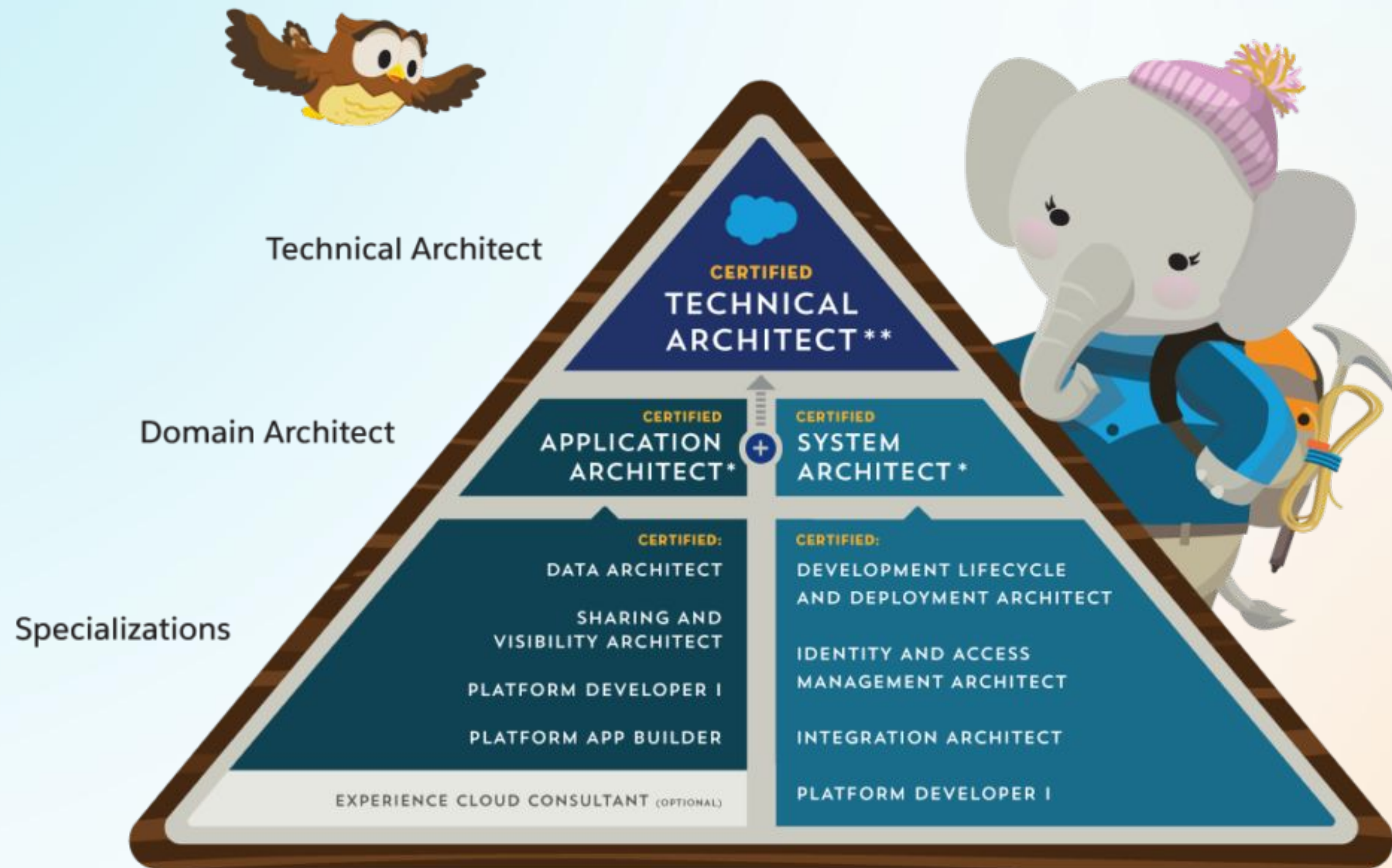
- Diagram-as-text.
- AI can draft it.
- Git can version it.
- Perfect for fast first-pass flows and ERDs inside a PR or doc.

Ideation aids

- Whiteboards (FigJam, Miro), sticky-note mapping, capability maps
- They are used for the messy thinking before the clean diagram.

What to learn next

You're already halfway up the pyramid



RELATED CERTIFICATION: CERTIFIED ADMINISTRATOR (OPTIONAL)

* Credential earned upon completion of exams within the specializations tier, no additional exam requirements.

** Credential earned upon successful completion of the Architect Review Board Evaluation and the Architect Review Board Exam.

What to learn next

You're already halfway up the pyramid



Developer

Architect

Application Architect	Data	Data modeling, relationships, field types, SOQL, Data Loader	LDV & indexing, Big Objects, ETL choice, data governance
	Sharing & Visibility	OWDs, roles, profiles & perm sets, sharing rules, FLS, Apex sharing	Sharing at scale (skew, LDV), teams/territories, external users, license impact
System Architect	Development Lifecycle and Deployment	Metadata deploy, source control & branching, PRs, releases, test classes	DevOps/release design, environment strategy at scale, CI/CD setup, multi-org governance
	Integration	REST/SOAP/Bulk APIs, sync vs. async, platform events, securing callouts	choosing the pattern, integration blueprint, designing for platform limits, resilience & error handling
	Identity and Access Management	Authentication vs. Authorization, OAuth in practice, MFA, Connected/External Client Apps, basic SSO & social sign-on	SAML depth (IdP vs. SP), federated vs. delegated SSO, JIT, enterprise SSO strategy

You don't need a new title to start. Pick one Today!



Question the ticket before building!

Don't build the ask as written. Ask why it exists and what it's missing, before you write a line.



Draw before you build!

Sketch the ticket's flow or data model before you build.



Pick the right tool, not the familiar one!

Your default is code. On your next requirement, ask what clicks could do first, then pick what's right for the job, not what's comfortable.



Write down the why!

Made a decision : one approach over another? Write a few lines: the context, the options, the why. TAs call it an ADR. That's your first one.



Get in the room!

Next design or solution discussion, ask to sit in and make it useful: take notes or draft the decision record.



Own a small design!

Ask to own the design of one feature end-to-end, not just the build.



Resources



Take it all with you

slides · recording · resources

Thank you

